CLIMATE & ENVIRONMENT

The carbon books, reconciled

National inventories and satellite measurements are being read against each other – not as a headline, but as an accounting problem.

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The ledger, and the Earth from orbit. · AI-generated image

In the climate crisis, national greenhouse gas inventories kept by governments serve as official, yet slow-moving ledgers of what is burned and released. [1] Today, however, satellites in orbit measure methane plumes and changes in carbon dioxide, opening a completely independent set of books. Scientists use this data to question the discrepancies between official paper figures and what the atmosphere shows – such as a missing landfill or a revised emission factor. [2] As synthesis reports by the IPCC and NASA unequivocally state, warming is human-driven. [1] [3] Reconciling orbital books with state ledgers isn't about declaring a winner; it increases the resolution on exactly which sectors need a closer audit to save the planet.

Sources

1. IPCC – Sixth Assessment Report, Synthesis
https://www.ipcc.ch/report/ar6/syr/

2. IEA – Global Methane Tracker 2026
https://www.iea.org/reports/global-methane-tracker-2026

3. NASA – Climate change: evidence
https://science.nasa.gov/climate-change/evidence/